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INTERNATIONAL COMMITTEE OF LEGAL METROLOGY

TWENTY-SECOND MEETING

Paris : 2nd, 3rd and 4th September, 1987

MINUTES

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TWENTY-SECOND MEETING
of the
INTERNATIONAL COMMITTEE of LEGAL METROLOGY

Paris : 2nd, 3rd and 4th September, 1987

The International Committee of Legal Metrology was convened by its President, Mr K. BIRKELAND, and met in Paris at the premises of the Office International des Epizooties on the 2nd, 3rd and 4th September, 1987.

LIST OF PERSONS ATTENDING

The following persons were present :

Federal Republic of Germany	: M. KOCHSIEK E. SEILER	Member, CIML
German Democratic Republic	: K. HASCHE	Member, CIML
Australia	: J. BIRCH	Member, CIML
Austria	: R. LEWISCH	Member, CIML
Belgium	: M.L. HENRION (Mrs)	Member, CIML
Bulgaria	: V. GAVRAÏLOV B. VELITCHKOVA (Mrs)	
Canada	: R.G. KNAPP J.P. LACHAINE	Member, CIML
People's Republic of China	: SONG YONGLIN WEI HONG (Mrs)	Member, CIML
Cuba	: J. GOMEZ ROSELL	Member, CIML
Denmark	: O.E. PETERSEN	Member, CIML
Spain	: M. CADARSO	Member, CIML
United States of America	: D.E. EDGERLY S.E. CHAPPELL	V. President of CIML to 1987-09-04 Member, CIML from 1987-09-04
Finland	: U. LÄHTEENMÄKI (Mrs)	Member, CIML
France	: P. BERTRAN A. LE BOUCH	Member, CIML
Guinea	: I. CAMARA T. DIALLO	
Hungary	: D. BELEDI A. SZILVÁSSY	Member, CIML
Ireland	: P. FANNING	Member, CIML
Italy	: C. AMODEO	Member, CIML
Japan	: S. HATTORI C. ANCELOT (Mrs)	Member, CIML (interpreter)
Morocco	: M. BENKIRANE	Member, CIML
Monaco	: A. VEGLIA	Member, CIML
Norway	: K. BIRKELAND K. LINDLØV	President of CIML
Netherlands	: G.J. FABER W.F. KOOL	Member, CIML
Poland	: T. PODGORSKI Z. REFEROWSKI	Member, CIML
Portugal	: A. CRUZ	Member, CIML

United Kingdom	:	P.B. CLAPHAM	Member, CIML
Sweden	:	R. OHLON H. ANDERSON H. LUNDAHL	Member, CIML
Switzerland	:	P. KOCH	Member, CIML
Tanzania	:	A.H.M. TUKAI	Member, CIML
Czechoslovakia	:	M. CIBAK M. SUTEK	Member, CIML
U.S.S.R.	:	L.K. ISSAEV A.S. VISHENKOV	V.President of CIML
Yugoslavia	:	M. MEZEK	Member, CIML

International Bureau of Legal Metrology :

B. ATHANÉ, S.A. THULIN, F. PETIK, W.H. EMERSON

Interpreters :

Mrs A. GIANNINI, Mrs B. HÉTIER, Mrs A. ROCHA, Mrs C. MARTEAU

Delegation of votes :

DJEUNG KI TCHEUL (Pop. Dem. Rep. of Korea) to L.K. ISSAEV (USSR),
M.K. SALEM (Egypt) to D.E. EDGERLY (U.S.A.),
G.M. PUTERA (Indonesia) to S. HATTORI (Japan),
A. BENGAID (Tunisia) to P. BERTRAN (France).

Apologies :

Brazil, Cameroon, Cyprus, Republic of Korea, Ethiopia, Greece, India, Israel,
Kenya, Pakistan, Rumania, Sri Lanka.

Countries which had not nominated a Committee Member :

Algeria, Lebanon.

OPENING ADDRESS

by K. BIRKELAND, President of the Committee

Ladies and Gentlemen,

It gives me great pleasure to welcome you, happily a large number, to the twenty second meeting of our Committee, meeting as agreed eighteen months ago in April 1986 when we commemorated, in this same room, OIML's first thirty years.

It is good to look back on the past from time to time to remind ourselves of the deeds of our predecessors and, as sometimes happens, to receive inspiration which enables us to prepare and build a better future.

Today we shall not be looking back but, on the contrary, we shall be looking to the future, to the next four or five years. This twenty-second meeting of the Committee will actually be mainly devoted to preparations for the Eighth International Conference of Legal Metrology which, in October 1988, is required to lay down the broad lines of OIML's activities for the next four-year period and provide our Organization, its working groups and its Bureau with the people, money and equipment needed to make this programme of work a reality.

But before coming to these future matters I would like, as is usual, to make a rapid survey of the events which have been prominent in the life of OIML since our last meeting.

First of all it was with great sadness that we learned of the death at the beginning of this year of our greatly esteemed colleague from Monaco, Alain VATRICAN, Secretary General of the Scientific Centre of Monaco and Member of our International Committee since May, 1973.

Alain VATRICAN had participated actively in our meetings throughout those fourteen years, as well as in some of our working groups, particularly those on the measurement of pollution. It is a field in which the scientists of the Principality of Monaco have always taken a special interest.

I ask you to observe a moment's silence in his memory.

.. . . .

Thank you.

Let me welcome Mr VEGLIA, who represents the Principality of Monaco.

There have been other changes in the composition of our Committee.

Our former Vice-President, Walter MÜHE, announced last year both his approaching retirement and the name of his successor on the Committee, Dr KOCH-SIEK, who now represents the Federal Republic of Germany.

Other changes have occurred ;

in Australia, where Mr BIRCH has replaced Mr PETRY,

in Brazil, where Mr MASAO ITO has replaced Mr TAVORA VEADO,

in the Republic of Korea, where Mr SON BOCK-GILL has replaced Mr CHANG KI-JUNG,

in the Popular Democratic Republic of Korea, where Mr DJEUNG KI TCHEUL has replaced Mr TCHEU HWA TCHOUN,

in Egypt, where Mr SALEM has replaced Mr SOBHY,

in Guinea, where Mr CONDE has retired ; this country is represented by Messrs IBRAHIMA CAMARA and TANOU DIALLO,

in Japan, where Mr HATTORI has replaced Mr IIZUKA,

in the Netherlands, where Mr FABER has replaced Mr NIEUWLAND.

I have just received a letter from Mr HILL, President of the Office for Standards and Measurements in Czechoslovakia, informing me that he had to relinquish his duties in our Committee and that his country is from now on represented by Mr CIBAK.

In addition, at the beginning of the year, we have had the pleasure of welcoming a new Member State, the Portugal, which is represented by Mr CRUZ.

Finally, our Bureau has also undergone some changes in that Mr TURSKI has retired and been replaced by Dr EMERSON, who worked prior to his arrival here at the National Engineering Laboratory of the United Kingdom.

To all the new Members of the Committee and to the new member of the staff of the Bureau I am happy to voice again my welcome and sincere good wishes.

Let us turn now to the purpose of our meeting. As I mentioned earlier, it is mainly to begin preparing for our Eighth Conference, now only a year away.

Of course the Committee will have to deal with all matters of interest in the life of our Organization and it is not my intention to list them all in these opening remarks. Some, such as activities of relevance to developing countries, or liaison with other international institutions, will be studied in the course of our discussions on Thursday or Friday.

I would particularly like to draw your attention to three items. First, the technical activities of our Pilot Secretariats and our Reporting Secretariats, activities which are still the main *raison d'être* of OIML.

Three years ago we introduced a planning process into these activities, leading to the development of work programmes covering four-year periods. Although it is still too early to be able to draw any final conclusions about the good and bad effects of this planning exercise, we can now try to evaluate some of them with the hope of improving the process for the next planning period, which begins in 1989 and ends in 1992. Item 5 of our agenda will be entirely devoted to this study, which must be closely linked with item 6 on the activities of the various Secretariats.

An increase in the efficiency of our technical working groups and a more profitable use of the limited resources of our Members States' metrological services are, of course, ends in themselves. But we must not forget that any increase in the activities of our Pilot Secretariats or Reporting Secretariats has, in the short term, a direct effect on the situation at the Bureau. The latter has not benefitted from any increase in the number of its staff since 1973 ; and even if improved equipment has enabled it to meet an enormous increase in its responsibilities and tasks, we are bound to acknowledge that a point of saturation has been reached such that there is a risk of its becoming a bottleneck if the Bureau is granted no additional resources.

Our role during this meeting will be to study the situation and do our best to advise the Bureau as to how it should approach the Conference, with the best hope of success, in asking for the increase in staff and funds which it needs to meet the responsibilities which we entrust to it.

The third point which, in concluding, I should like to raise is, as you may have guessed, that of certification.

The creation of an OIML system of certification was not foreseen as one of the objectives listed in the Convention constituting OIML.

During the seventies it was, nevertheless, apparent that that represented an important goal, given the way in which our society has evolved, the increase in international trade, the need to improve product quality, and especially the extraordinary

diversity and complexity of these products. Their systematic control, using classical procedures applied by national certification organizations working independently of each other, is becoming an insurmountable task.

That is true in all technical fields, not only in metrology, and numerous international institutions are working, like OIML, to resolve these problems by trying to set up international certification systems which significantly diminish the load on national organizations.

Twelve years ago OIML became something of a pioneer in starting work on such a system. Perhaps we embarked on it too soon ? Anyway, our Committee concluded two years ago that the opportune moment to create the OIML Mark had not yet arrived.

However, events move along quickly, and today I wonder whether it might not be appropriate to reconsider the question. It is, I believe, the key to the future of our Organization, and it is my intention to devote whatever time is needed to it so that our discussions may, if it seems appropriate, result in new actions being placed on the Presidential Council and the Secretariat SP 2-Sr 4.

There Ladies, Gentlemen, dear Colleagues, are the main guidelines that I would like to give you, if you agree, for the next three days of meetings.

Before we get down to the real discussions I now call on the Director of the Bureau to call the roll of delegates and to give us any information he may have for us about the conduct of the meeting.

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STATEMENT by Mr CRUZ

CIML Member, Portugal

Thank you Mr President. I would like to take this opportunity to express my thanks and the wish that our labours will be successful. I think, as you do, that this is an important moment for our Organization ; and, after seven years of participation as a Corresponding Member, Portugal is joining at just the right moment to be associated with you in facing the problems being encountered by our Organization. I would also like to thank the Director of the Bureau for all the trouble he has taken and the efforts he has made to bring about our new status as a Member State. Thank you.

Roll-call of Delegates

After the opening speeches the roll of delegates was called. It was established that 36 Members of the Committee were present or represented out of a total of 48. The statutory quorum of three-quarters was attained.

Adoption of the Agenda

The Committee adopted the following agenda :

1. Approval of the minutes of the Twenty First meeting of the Committee
2. Member States and Corresponding Members
 - 2.1. New accessions ; expected accessions
 - 2.2. The situation of some Member States and Corresponding Members

3. Finance
 - 3.1. Approval of the Auditor's Reports for 1985 and 1986
 - 3.2. The financial position in 1987 and 1988
4. The Staff of the Bureau
 - 4.1. Staff whose contracts end between the date of the meeting and 1988
5. Work Planning
 - 5.1. Planning exercise for the period 1985 to 1988
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 - 8.3. Preliminary budgetary proposals for the financial period 1989 to 1992
9. Developing Countries
10. Categories of OIML publications
11. OIML Seminars
12. Report on the activities of BIML
13. Liaison with other international institutions
14. Terminology

MINUTES

1. APPROVAL OF THE MINUTES OF THE TWENTY-FIRST MEETING OF THE COMMITTEE

The Minutes were approved with the following amendments :

Page 6 : Delegation of votes ; add :

Mr ASAD HASAN (Pakistan) to Mr NIEUWLAND (Netherlands), 18th April

Page 8 : Second line (French version only) ; read « représentant » for « Membre ».

Page 11 : point 2.1, after « April 1985 » add « and new Corresponding Members (Costa-Rica, Ghana, Iceland and Oman)... »

Page 15 : after the four first lines, add the paragraph,

« The Committee noted that some Reporting Secretariats (SP 6-Sr 6, SP 17-Sr 3) had to be regarded as temporarily inactive because no country had volunteered to take responsibility for them. »

2. MEMBER STATES AND CORRESPONDING MEMBERS

2.1. New accessions ; expected accessions

Mr BIRKELAND reminded the Committee of the accession of PORTUGAL as a Member State and of that of BARBADOS as a Corresponding Member.

Mr ATHANÉ then said that the Bureau had been made aware of the possible future accession of Saudi Arabia, and had received enquiries from a number of countries such as Malasia, Mexico, Thailand, etc. He added that the Bureau advised developing countries to join as Corresponding Members if they were not confident of being able to undertake the responsibilities of a Member State.

2.2. The situation of some Member States and Corresponding Members

Mr ATHANÉ reported that Venezuela had asked to be considered as no longer a Member State, because of her economic difficulties.

3. FINANCE

3.1. Approval of the Auditor's reports for 1985 and 1986

The Committee approved these two reports and instructed its President and the Director of the Bureau to submit them to the Eighth Conference.

3.2. The financial position in 1987 and 1988

Mr ATHANÉ reported that at the end of 1986 and the beginning of 1987 OIML had been in a difficult financial position because seventeen Member States had not paid their subscriptions for 1986, so that it had had to make extensive use of its reserve fund to meet its expenses and had had to restrict the latter as much as possible to the bare essentials. In the course of 1987 the position had improved, a large part of the arrears having been paid and also many States having paid their subscriptions for 1987 promptly.

As for the expenses in 1987, the forecasts made at the end of 1986 seemed still to be correct, mainly due to a rate of inflation which had remained close to the predicted rate.

Mr ATHANÉ added that if there was no deterioration in the financial position between then and the end of 1987 the Bureau would proceed with the purchase of word-processing equipment, which was urgently needed. This expense, which was of an exceptional nature, would amount to about 150 000 French francs.

In 1988, Mr ATHANÉ said, the Member States' subscriptions would go up by only 4.5 per cent in relation to those of 1987, by the application of the decision of the Seventh Conference to reduce the budget to take account of the fall in the rate of inflation. Thus the sum of the contributory shares for 1988 would be 780 000 French francs less than the maximum sum voted by the Conference.

In reply to a question put by Mr PETERSEN, Mr ATHANÉ described the means adopted by the Bureau, using diplomatic channels and Members of the Committee as intermediaries, to remind Member States in arrears that they must pay their subscriptions with minimum delay.

Mr TUKAI suggested that reminders should be sent more frequently.

Messrs CLAPHAM, FANNING, KNAPP and PETERSEN emphasised that a word processor was an absolute necessity for the Bureau, given the amount of work that it had to do. They urged the Bureau to make this purchase as a matter of urgency, as soon as it became evident that a large part of the subscriptions for 1988 would be paid, without even waiting for their actual payment.

4. STAFF OF THE BUREAU

The Committee :

- renewed the contract of Mr THULIN, Assistant Director, to take effect from the expiry date of the current contract (September 1988) up to the age limit specified in the Bureau's Staff Rules ;
- renewed the contract of Mr PETIK, Assistant Director, for five years from the expiry date of his first contract (June 1986) (this decision annulled the decision taken in 1986 to prolong the contract by two years, in deference to the Hungarian administrative rules in application at that time).

5. WORK PLANNING

5.1. Planning exercise for the period 1985 to 1988

M. PETIK drew the attention of the Committee to the final drafts of the programmes of work that the Bureau had presented, in a uniform format, based on the draft work programmes drawn up by the Secretariats in 1985 and approved by the Committee in 1986. Although it was not then possible to draw any final conclusions it could be said that, of 150 Reporting Secretariats, 40 were inactive (their work being either finished or not yet started). Of the 110 active Secretariats, three quarters were proceeding according to plan and a quarter had slipped behind. There would be a more detailed analysis at the beginning of 1988, using the annual reports that the Bureau would receive before the end of 1987.

Finally Mr PETIK emphasised that, in his view, the work plans should be periodically brought up to date because, on the one hand, the work evolved quickly and, on the other, changes in countries' economic conditions could cause changes in the resources which the Member States were able to devote to OIML, as well as in the level of interest which Member States might have for any particular work. Another reason for periodic revision was that it was difficult to predict how many successive pre-drafts would be needed before agreement was reached among the collaborating countries.

In reply to a question from Mr OHLON, Mr PETIK said that it was impossible to specify particular areas of activity which were noticeably ahead of plan or were behind.

In response to a question from Mr PETERSEN, Mr ATHANÉ indicated that, out of 35 or 40 drafts which in 1985, could conceivably be submitted to the Eighth Conference for sanction, 20 to 25 were sufficiently advanced and would be submitted if the results of the postal ballots were favourable.

5.2. Preparation of the plan for the period 1989 to 1992

Mr BIRKELAND reminded the Committee of the reasons which had led it to decide to introduce a planning system for the work of OIML, and to instruct the Presidential Council to prepare the system and to put it into effect. The second planning period, for the years 1989 to 1992, should by then be entering its planning phase, even if the results of the first period were far from being known in their entirety. Experience had shown that the problem of setting priority criteria, that is the importance to be attached to each work topic, had not been completely resolved, and that this question needed to be studied in depth before constructing the plan for the second period. For that purpose the Bureau had submitted proposals which stemmed from ideas and comments put forward by some Committee Members.

Mr BERTRAN was convinced of the need to set priorities, because plans could not be made in a vacuum, without being based on some priority criteria. He feared, nevertheless, that the list of eleven criteria submitted by the Bureau was too extensive : too many priorities meant no priorities ! He proposed that the Committee limit itself to five or six priorities, as proposed by the Netherlands, and that it should select, not priorities, but criteria. Each work topic could be examined to see which criteria were satisfied (for example : a request from another institution, elimination of technical barriers and the revision of an outdated Recommendation, satisfy simultaneously three criteria). The topics which satisfy simultaneously the largest number of criteria should have the highest priority.

Mr CLAPHAM expressed his general support for Mr BERTRAN's remarks. He added that it should not be forgotten that the aim of OIML, deriving from the Convention, was the unification of regulations and methods of control in the field of legal metrology. Criteria numbers 1 and 3 in the list proposed by the Bureau were entirely relevant to the aim of unification. But other criteria, such as numbers 5, 6 and 7, though of great importance from a technical and economic viewpoint, did not have the same degree of importance for OIML, for they were not part of legal metrology, or at least in many countries such as the United Kingdom.

M. FABER also thought that OIML should limit its range of activities by deciding upon priorities. OIML had been much more active in recent years and could not continue to do more and more without the risk of compromising the efficiency of the Organization. The government of the Netherlands was very anxious not to see the work of OIML, and hence the demands on money and staff, increase beyond that which was strictly needed. For that it was imperative, difficult though the task might be, to succeed in establishing work priorities and then observing them.

Messrs PETERSEN and OHLON gave their views on the list of priorities submitted by the Bureau, particularly with regard to the regrouping of some of the criteria.

Mr OHLON added that the criteria submitted by the Bureau were of different kinds and that it was difficult to put them side by side or to compare them. He supported Mr CLAPHAM in the belief that criteria numbers 1, 2 and 10 were of the greatest importance, given the objectives of OIML as determined by the Convention. Sweden, likewise, did not consider criteria 5, 6 and 7 to be in the field of legal metrology.

Mr BIRKELAND remarked that the Committee should not discuss the priorities by which it would decide what topics should be included in OIML's work programme without keeping in mind the fact that other factors weigh in these decisions ; in particular the number of States agreeing to participate in the work.

Up to then five P-Members had been enough to create a Reporting Secretariat. For the future it would no doubt be necessary to increase that number ; but in fact the greater the priority attached to a work topic, the greater are the number of States wishing to participate in the work.

Mr FANNING was in full agreement with that idea, though he feared that there would be difficulties in settling on too high a figure for the minimum number of P-Members. It was to be hoped that the revision of former Recommendations would feature among the priority criteria to be retained.

Mr FABER explained how the Netherlands had chosen to retain only some of the criteria proposed by the Bureau : requests from other international institutions, problems arising from new technologies applied to measuring instruments used in trade, the needs of health and security, all appeared to be of high priority and ought to receive the maximum of attention from the Secretariats of OIML, to the detriment of other topics of much lower priority.

Mr OHLON, referring again to the objectives of the Organization laid down in the Convention, repeated that items 1 and 3 of the list submitted by the Bureau ought to receive the highest priority. And particularly as regards item 1, special attention should be given, he said, to cooperation between OIML and the European organizations concerned with metrology and standardization. He thought, on the other hand, that care should be taken not to give priority to subjects already dealt with by other institutions such as ISO, IEC, WHO, etc.

Mr CLAPHAM strongly supported that view. He thought that, as well as « positive » criteria, there could be « negative » criteria, that is criteria of low priority. The fact that a subject was already dealt with by ISO or IEC would be one such criterion of low priority. Certainly one would have to be careful and not delete from the OIML programme all subjects treated by another institution. It could happen that it was that other institution that was encroaching on OIML's territory ; and it might also be desirable that two institutions, one of which was OIML, should work simultaneously on the subject from different points of view.

Mr EDGERLY expressed his complete agreement with what Mr CLAPHAM had said. He also thought that Mr BERTRAN was absolutely right in making a distinction between « criteria » and « priorities ». in the real sense. He thought that the list submitted by the Bureau should be revised and arranged more logically. For example, criteria numbers 5, 6 and 7 were only sub-sets of criterion number 4. Criterion number 8 was just one particular example of criterion number 2. Thus the list could be reduced to a more reasonable number of criteria and the latter could then be used more easily by the Pilot Secretariats in planning their work programmes (with the additional need, as Mr CLAPHAM had said, to avoid unnecessary duplication of the work of other institutions).

At Mr PETERSEN's request, Mr BIRKELAND said that the list submitted by the Bureau did not make proposals for new work for which new Pilot Secretariats should be set up, but criteria by which existing Secretariats could decide whether or not a topic should be included in the draft work programmes which they would submit to the Committee for acceptance.

Mr EMERSON remarked that the eleven criteria could be divided into two groups : numbers 1, 2, 3, 9, 10 and 11 constituted motivations for working on a given subject, while numbers 4, 5, 6, 7 and 8 referred to particular technical fields. The Committee could confine its discussion to the first group ; it was not really possible to discuss motivations and technical fields at the same time.

Mr BIRKELAND expressed satisfaction with the debate which had just taken place. He thought, nevertheless, that it was not possible to arrive immediately at any definite conclusions. It was no doubt necessary to go on thinking about this

fundamental problem and he invited his colleagues to send in any additional views that they might have to the Bureau, after the meeting. He thought that the Bureau could then study all the opinions that had been expressed during the meeting, or afterwards by correspondence, and submit this compilation to the Presidential Council meeting in January 1988. By this means concrete proposals could no doubt be submitted to the Committee in good time for the twenty-third meeting, during which the work programmes for 1989 to 1992 would be adopted.

Mr ATHANÉ submitted some proposals on the manner in which the Bureau could advance the study of the subject, especially to try to classify the criteria in relation to each other.

Mr KOCH thought that it might well be interesting to try to classify the criteria by importance but, in any case, the question of available means would arise. It was no use considering a subject to be very important if a working group could not be found to take it on.

Following the discussion the Committee adopted the following resolution :

The International Committee of Legal Metrology,

HAVING TAKEN NOTE of the comments, submitted by certain Member States, on the preparations for the planning period 1989 to 1992,

HAVING TAKEN NOTE of the proposals of the Bureau,

HAVING HEARD the oral comments of Committee Members,

NOTING that planning criteria are required so that the plan for 1989 to 1992 may be prepared in time,

INVITES Committee Members to inform the Bureau of their views on planning criteria and priorities and on the criteria for the inclusion of a subject in the work programme,

INSTRUCTS the Bureau to compile the information and views of Committee Members on this subject and to bring them to the attention of the Presidential Council.

CHARGES the Presidential Council with considering and weighing the views expressed and making a recommendation to the Twenty-third meeting of the Committee,

INSTRUCTS the Bureau to proceed with the other aspects of the planning exercise for the period 1989 to 1992 in accordance with the proposals of BIML presented at the meeting.

6. WORK OF THE SECRETARIATS

6.1. State of progress of work

Mr BIRKELAND introduced the paper, « State of progress of the work of the Secretariats of OIML », of which an updated edition had been distributed to all participants. The paper aroused no comment.

6.2. Particular Secretariats (creation, abolition, assignment of responsibilities)

Mr ATHANÉ gave an account of the situation in which some of the Secretariats found themselves and with regard to which the Committee made the following decisions :

- SP 2-Sr 3 : « Legal qualification of measuring instruments » : this Secretariat was abolished at the request of SP 2, for its activities are entirely covered by SP 22. The revision of DI 3, if needed, will be undertaken by SP 22 in liaison with the Bureau.

- SP 5-Sr 12 : « Static direct mass measurement of liquids » : an enquiry by the Bureau had shown that the creation of this new Secretariat had aroused great interest among Member States. Responsibility for the Secretariat was assigned to Australia. The Bureau was instructed to proceed with setting up the international working group (P-Members, O-Members and links with other institutions) of this Secretariat.
- SP 5D-Sr 10 : « Direct mass flow measurement of quantities of liquids » : an enquiry by the Bureau had shown that the creation of this new Secretariat had aroused great interest among Member States. Responsibility for the Secretariat was assigned to the United States of America (Hungary, who had envisaged putting herself forward, having since withdrawn). The Bureau was instructed to proceed with setting up the international working group. Mr THULIN mentioned that two very interesting papers on this subject had been presented at the seminar at Arles (see point 11 below). It was also noted that a working group of ISO (attached to TC 30) also dealt with mass flow meters.
- SP 11-Sr 2 : « Hierarchy scheme for pressure measuring instruments » : Poland having given up responsibility for this Secretariat, the responsibility was assigned to the German Democratic Republic.
- SP 14-Sr 1 : « Sound meters » : Switzerland having given up responsibility for this Secretariat, the responsibility was assigned to the People's Republic of China (the German Dem. Rep., who had also been a candidate, having withdrawn her candidature in favour of China).
- SP 14-Sr 3 : « Mechanical vibration and shock » : Denmark having given up responsibility for this Secretariat, the responsibility was assigned to the German Democratic Republic. Mr THULIN mentioned the work of ISO in this field and suggested that the work of OIML could be based, at least in part, on the work of ISO.
- SP 23-Sr 6 : « Principles of horizontal intercomparisons (measuring standards of the same level) » : the proposal to create this new Secretariat had been made by SP 23 and had aroused great interest among Member States ; however, no country had volunteered to undertake responsibility for it ; the Committee decided to postpone its decision to a later date.
- SP 23-Sr 7 : « Recalibration intervals of measurement standards and devices used for calibration and verification » : the proposal to create this new Secretariat had been made by SP 23 and had aroused great interest among Member States. Responsibility for the Secretariat was assigned to Czechoslovakia, and the Bureau was instructed to proceed with setting up the international working group. Messrs CIBAK and BIRKELAND underlined the importance of the work of this new Secretariat in the context of cooperation between ILAC and OIML.
- SP 27-Sr 6 : « Prescriptions concerning the contents of reference material certificates » and SP 27-Sr 7 : « Information concerning reference materials » : in accordance with a proposal from SP 27, these two Secretariats were abolished, for, as they had not yet begun work, the latter could be taken over by other Secretariats and thereby the administration of SP 27 would be simplified.

In addition the Committee noted :

- the new names for SP 22-Sr 4 : « Principles for the initial and subsequent verification of instruments » and for SP 23 : « Measurement standards and devices used for calibration and verification »,
- France's request to be relieved of her responsibility for SP 5S : « Static measurement of quantities of liquids ».

6.3. Working method of OIML Secretariats

Mr BIRKELAND pointed out that the document « Working Method of OIML Secretariats » was now some years old and should therefore be well known and

correctly applied by Secretariats. It had to be said, however, that on certain occasions, and particularly at meetings, this working method had not always been correctly put into practice and that some participants were completely unaware of its existence. It was worth considering, therefore, how knowledge and application of this document could be improved. It would also be appropriate to improve and complete the paper in the light of the experience which had been gained and perhaps to take account of the new procedures arising from the planning process. Such a republication would, in any case, have the advantage of drawing attention to the document, particularly that of the new experts who had not been actively participating two or three years earlier, when the preceding edition had been published.

Mr BIRKELAND concluded his introduction in stressing the importance of the document, not only for the internal working of OIML, but also as an informative document on the activities of OIML which was useful to all the international institutions which cooperated with OIML or who were concerned with metrology.

Mr ATHANÉ thought that one of the reasons why the Working Method was less well observed was that the Bureau had not, in the past two years, been able to take part in meetings of Secretariats as much as it had done formerly, for two reasons :

- the increased work load which prevented staff of the Bureau having enough time to make the journeys needed to participate,
- the Bureau's financial difficulties, which had meant that the Director had to manage expenditure very carefully and to restrict travel expenses, which were already very high, as much as possible.

Mr ATHANÉ also thought that it would be opportune to produce a brief summary of the Working Method, focused on the holding of meetings. The summary could be made available to all organizers of OIML meetings so that the participants might be made aware of the main working rules.

Finally, Mr ATHANÉ recognized that during the last twelve to eighteen months some aspects of the Working Method, particularly those concerning time scales, had not always been observed for it had sometimes been necessary to speed things up to make sure that drafts would be ready for the Conference.

Mr PETERSEN thought that the Working Method was good as it was. In fact, what could be criticised were the excessive differences that sometimes existed between the ways of working of this or that Secretariat ; it was more the application of the Working Method, rather than the Method itself, that needed to be re-considered.

Mr EDGERLY was of the same opinion. It was not a question of an inadequate Working Method, but of experts in need of education. He also approved of the idea of preparing a summary giving the essential working rules, particularly those for the conduct of meetings : at every meeting the chairman should devote fifteen or twenty minutes to reviewing this summary and make sure that all the participants were well aware of the Working Method. Perhaps some improvements could be made, but no doubt they would be marginal. Mr EDGERLY concluded by saying that it was an important responsibility of every Member of the Committee to ensure that the national experts who organised or chaired meetings, or who supported or participated in the work of the Secretariat, were fully conversant with the Working Method.

Mr KOCH asked that people organising OIML meetings pay more attention to the difficulties of travel : times of flights, fares etc. For example, if a meeting started at noon, participants from neighbouring countries could travel to it in the morning and thereby save the expense of a night in a hotel, provided that the venue was near enough to the airport. Having to travel at the weekend had some disadvantages, but sometimes offered the advantage of reduced air fares. Advice on these matters could be given in the Working Method.

Mr BIRCH thought that the organisation and planning of meetings was a matter that should be re-examined. For countries far removed from Europe, such as Australia, an expert could not spend twenty four hours in an aeroplane to attend a meeting lasting two days, and then return home. The lack of coordination between dates and venues of meetings was a great hindrance to Australia's participation and that of other countries in the work of OIML. The importance attached to speeding up the work to increase the number of Recommendations, as cited by the Director of the Bureau, was certainly understandable, but a much more important factor was that the Recommendations be unanimously accepted and applied by the Member States ; and for that it was essential that all the Member States be able to participate effectively in the work, without being hindered by problems of time limits, travel, etc. The participants in the Eighth Conference would be able to judge for themselves what was entailed in a journey between Europe and Australia, and they would then realise the difficulties faced by remote countries in participating in the work of the Secretariats.

Mr BIRCH concluded by asking that a recommendation be included in the Working Method whereby several OIML meetings should be organised at certain times of the year at the same or neighbouring places. That would help not only the remote countries to participate, but also all the others, for they would even be able to plan their experts' travel.

Mr BIRKELAND recognised that Mr BIRCH's remarks were well founded and observed that the Secretariats were beginning to make an effort to coordinate their meetings. He also drew attention to the possibility of taking part in the work of OIML by correspondence.

Mr THULIN observed that countries which could not attend meetings sometimes failed to take advantage of the opportunity that was given to take part in the work by correspondence ; they did not make their views known when the text was still at the preliminary-draft stage, and it was not until the final stage had been reached that they reacted and made known their views, by which time it was often too late to take them into account.

Mr KOCH thought that the development of Telefax would enable an exchange of views with countries who had not sent representatives to take place while a meeting was going on.

Following this discussion the Committee adopted the following Resolution :

The International Committee of Legal Metrology,

HAVING TAKEN NOTE of the comments on the « Working Method of OIML Secretariats » submitted by some Member States,

HAVING TAKEN NOTE of the Bureau's proposals,

HAVING HEARD the oral comments of Committee Members,

RECOGNISING that the provisions contained in the « Working Method of OIML Secretariats » are in general entirely appropriate,

CONSIDERING nevertheless that some points of detail could be completed or improved,

CONSIDERING that the problems that arise are almost always due to incorrect implementation of these provisions, mainly due to their being poorly known,

INSTRUCTS the Bureau to proceed to the necessary improvements and adaptations, under the supervision of the Presidential Council,

INSTRUCTS the Bureau to prepare summaries of these provisions, particularly for the information of persons attending Secretariats' meetings,

REMINDS the Members of the Committee that it is their duty to ensure that the Secretariats for which their countries are responsible or in which their countries participate adhere strictly to these provisions.

7. CERTIFICATION

Mr BIRKELAND introduced this item by stressing the importance for OIML of the question of mutual recognition of metrological controls and, more generally, of what was meant by international certification. The internationalization of the exchange of merchandise, goods and services had increased significantly in all fields, including that of metrology. At the same time, national metrological services had often seen their resources diminishing or stagnating at their present level, or at any rate not increasing as rapidly as the volume of work. A way of resolving some of the problems encountered at local level lay, no doubt, in the solution of the problems of international certification, thanks to better rationalization of activity.

Mr BIRKELAND also drew attention to the fact that many regional and international organizations were engaged in certification, and he added that OIML too had a role to play. He cited all the work done on this subject by OIML during the previous dozen or so years, before asking the Bureau to indicate the points which the Committee needed to discuss.

Mr PETIK began his introduction with a brief account of the studies already completed and of the decisions taken by the Conference and the Committee. On his suggestion the application of the resolutions adopted by the Committee in April 1986 was studied, one by one.

a) Bilateral or multilateral agreements

Mr PETIK reminded Committee Members that they had been invited to send to the Bureau, if they could and thought it useful, details of any bilateral or multilateral agreements in which their countries were participants. The Bureau had summarised the information. Only agreements dealing strictly with legal metrology were included, not general agreements like those on accreditation.

Mr CLAPHAM thought that this exclusion of general agreements was dangerous. Already, and increasingly in the future, agreements on metrological matters were being and would be caught up in more general agreements on questions of the accreditation of test laboratories.

Mr PETIK said that he was well aware of that but that he would have to try, nevertheless, to draw a dividing line between the agreements which were relevant to or which included legal metrology, and those which did not concern it. The Bureau would see to it that this demarcation was as nearly as possible correctly done, and the general agreements which included metrology would be systematically catalogued.

Mr BIRKELAND drew attention to an aspect of the agreement concluded between the EFTA countries which he thought was important : of the five heads of the agreement, the fifth related to the fact that OIML Recommendations should, to every possible extent, be used as the basis for reciprocal recognition. In his view it was very important that the Members of CIML introduce such a reference to OIML in the bilateral or multilateral agreements that are signed by their countries.

Finally some countries, among them Hungary, informed the Committee of agreements recently concluded.

b) Exchanges of information on the results of pattern approval evaluations

Mr PETIK gave an account of the information on this subject that had been received by the Bureau.

Mr FABER gave some insight into the very flexible and informal way in which the Netherlands sought information on pattern approval, evaluations already completed in other countries.

Mr ISSAEV proposed that very brief announcements about the various pattern approvals given by Member States be published in the Bulletin.

Mr ATHANÉ, replying to that proposal, said that, interesting though it was, there were very great difficulties in the way : the number of approvals, the translation into French or English, or both, of pattern approvals given in other languages, the difficulty of identifying with absolute certainty the pattern concerned, etc.

Mr KOCH reported that Switzerland envisaged supplying the manufacturer, first on demand, but later systematically, with declarations of conformity which the manufacturer could then present to the metrological services of another country. There was the current difficulty that the legal requirements in force were not completely identical to those of OIML, but they were being brought into line.

c) Declarations of conformity of an instrument or of a series of instruments

Mr PETIK said that the Bureau had not received any reports on the use being made of the « declaration of conformity » recommended by the Committee.

Mr PETERSEN said that Denmark was setting up a system for issuing such certificates, for they were of great interest to the manufacturers who had already approached the Danish Council of Metrology on that subject to obtain details. The manufacturers had also asked whether these certificates could also extend to ISO or IEC. Mr PETERSEN said that his reply was always that these certificates were limited strictly to the requirements of legal metrology as laid down by OIML, without, however, restricting them to fields of metrology legal in Denmark. For Danish manufacturers the chief attraction of these certificates was in marketing and exporting, to prove conformity with OIML.

In Mr PETERSEN's view such certificates could, moreover, open the door to a more elaborate system of certification, including mutual recognition of tests.

Mr PETERSEN added that in the immediate future, the individual certificates issued in Denmark would be from specially authorised laboratories under the supervision of the Danish authorities. The system of individual certificates would exist in parallel with the system for pattern approval, and would be mainly an aid to export ; the certificates would therefore be issued on the demand of the manufacturer, on whom would continue to rest the responsibility for conformity to the requirements. Finally, the form and content of the certificates would have to be strictly defined : for example, the use of the OIML logo ; or again, details of the methods of measurements used by the authorised laboratory, etc.

Mr THULIN reminded the Committee that originally its decision to institute a declaration of conformity was founded on the needs of the developing countries who imported measuring instruments ; the metrological services of these countries could thus be certain that the instruments imported, identified in the declaration by their numbers, had already been examined by a service of an industrialised country and found to conform to OIML.

Mr KOCH thought that, for the mass export of instruments, a declaration of conformity was inappropriate and that an OIML mark would be preferable.

Mr OHLON observed, first that the terminology used by OIML on this subject (declaration or attestation of conformity) was not in conformity with that of ISO Guide No. 2. He then indicated that nothing prevented the issue of such a certificate in Sweden, but the main difficulty which presented itself was the lack of harmonization with regard to the requirements for electronic devices.

Mr PETERSEN added to his previous remarks by saying that in his opinion it would be useful to publicise the system so that the manufacturers knew of its existence and were in a position to ask the national authorities to issue such certificates.

d) Mention of conformity to the requirements of OIML in pattern-approval decisions

Mr PETIK reminded the Committee that at its meeting in April 1986 it had looked at the possibility of recommending that Member States include in their national pattern approvals a note to the effect, if such was the case, that the pattern concerned conformed, in whole or in part, to the requirements of the relevant OIML Recommendations. That proposal was not approved by the Committee (see minutes of the Twenty-first Meeting of CIML, point 13.1). In the meantime the Bureau had concluded that the original idea could be taken up again in another form and had suggested to the Presidential Council that the matter be re-examined. At the beginning of 1987 Mr BIRKELAND had put before the Council a draft declaration of conformity applicable to a *pattern* of a measuring instrument (and not to a well identified instrument or series of instruments, as in « c » above). This draft was well received when sent to the Members of the Committee, though only twelve Members replied.

Mr SEILER said that the PTB was taking a first step in informing manufacturers in the Federal Republic of Germany that such declarations of conformity to the requirements of OIML Recommendations could be supplied where the said Recommendations were sufficiently complete to enable the pattern of the instrument and its characteristics to be correctly specified. The form developed by the Nordic countries had been used as a model. Mr SEILER added that he hoped for a favourable reaction from the manufacturers, and that other countries would follow this initiative, which was a necessary stage towards the establishment of a more complete and all-encompassing system of certification.

Mrs LÄHTEENMÄKI said that there had been much thought in her country about the administrative and technical problems arising from the possible introduction of declarations of conformity. It had become apparent that if it were introduced the field would be clear for an overall OIML system of certification, and so this proposal was considered to be entirely acceptable.

Mr KOCH considered that the issue of declarations of conformity constituted a first step ; a second step would be the recognition of those certificates. This recognition could be done very flexibly, a country being able to decide to recognise the declarations of this or that country, for this or that type of instrument.

Mr OHLON thought that such certificates would be particularly useful if they were accompanied by the results of tests, as proposed by Austria. Moreover OIML should take inspiration from what was being done in other fields, especially in electronics, where schemes of mutual recognition were already in existence.

Mr BERTRAN, continuing Mr OHLON's line of thought, added that these declarations would have to make a distinction between information and approval. A manufacturer should not make those of his customers who were ill-acquainted with national metrological requirements think that an instrument endowed with an OIML declaration of conformity was legally acceptable in any country.

Mr BIRKELAND expressed his approval of what had just been said. Originally the declaration of conformity was suppose to be issued by one metrological service at the request of another. But what Mr SEILER had described would be a document issued by a service but used by the manufacturer concerned. The way in which the document was drawn up should clearly show its limits of applicability, so that no one might be tempted to misuse it.

Mr PETERSEN considered that the use of these declarations of conformity would be greatly eased if a revised model form, with notes on its use, were devised by the Bureau.

Mr KOCH also thought that it would be wise to publish a list of Recommendations with respect to which these declarations might be made.

Mr SEILER undertook to send information about PTB's experience in this matter to the Bureau as soon as possible.

Mr EMERSON remarked that declarations of conformity could be supplied for instruments in a given country without regard to whether or not the instruments were subject to legal metrological control in that country. In the long run that could induce users to buy only those instruments which were the subject of such declarations and so bring pressure on their administrations to bring in regulations which were in conformity with OIML.

Mr BIRKELAND closed the discussion by asking the Bureau to review the draft declaration of conformity, to amend it and if necessary complete it, to consider which Recommendations could be cited in declarations of conformity, and for what types of instruments, and to inform the Council of the results. Then a developed proposal could be sent to Committee Members with the suggestion that they contemplate issuing certificates of conformity on an entirely voluntary basis.

e) Future activities with regard to certification

Mr BIRKELAND reminded the Committee that in 1983 it had examined the proposals from an ad-hoc group and has concluded (1) that it could not at that time envisage the creation of an OIML system of certification. The Committee had asked the Bureau to preserve the files relating to this work for possible later use and to carry out through SP 2-Sr 4 some specific actions to resolve particular problems and ease the future establishment of an OIML system of certification.

Mr BIRKELAND observed that there had been a rapid evolution of the situation with the development of regional certification (for example within the European Economic Community), bilateral agreements, the efforts of ISO, IEC, ILAC, etc. It could be asked whether the time had not come to reconsider the question and perhaps to begin work again on the creation of an OIML system of certification.

Mr ISSAEV drew his colleagues' attention to a written comment from the USSR in the Bureau's paper : the basis of the future OIML system of certification could only be constituted by a set of Recommendations laying down specifications, verification procedures and test methods applicable to the instruments concerned. Since a complete set of OIML Recommendations did not exist, a certification system could not be established.

Mr KOCH was in general agreement with Mr ISSAEV. He observed, however, that the various laboratories or services in various countries were not identically equipped and doubtless it would be difficult for them to carry out all the standard procedures for the checking of instruments. Mr KOCH thought that in the first place Recommendations were needed which stipulated the requirements applicable to the instruments proper, and that harmonization of the equipment and methods of control would come later.

Mr ATHANÉ thought it useful to draw attention to a point which was made in a paper submitted by Finland : if, as envisaged in the Convention, national regulations were based on the OIML Recommendations, national pattern approvals would automatically constitute recognition of conformity to OIML. The establishment of the certification system would certainly thus be made easier.

Mr OHLON expressed his support for what had just been said and thought that national regulations ought to be identical to the Recommendations and not just based on them. It was also important to harmonise the means by which conformity

(1) CIML Resolution 1983 — Point 8.

to the requirements was proven. Finally it was extremely important to create a climate of mutual confidence between the people whose task it was to do the tests. In fact a sufficiently high level of reproducibility between laboratories was needed, and that implied at the same time the use of uniform test procedures and adequate competence on the part of the various laboratories. The Nordic experience showed how profitable was cooperation at the practical level between the people who effectively were expected to do the tests.

As regarded the way in which the OIML system of certification, properly speaking, would work, Mr OHLON proposed the introduction of an « OIML Mark ». However, this « OIML Mark » was not to be confused with the logo used by the Bureau on its letter head and the documents it published. A distinction would also have to be made between « Mark » and « Certification System » and for that reference should be made to ISO Guide N° 2. In effect, OIML would never be the « certifying body », able itself to direct a certification system, as defined by ISO. On the other hand the « OIML Mark » could be attributed the following significance : tests had been done which proved that the product satisfied the requirements of OIML ; this mark might or might not, moreover, be supplemented by a national mark.

Mr KOCH indicated that in Switzerland preparations were in hand to accept, for certain instruments, initial verifications done by certain other countries (with, on the part of the Swiss authorities, second degree control by sampling). However, it would be difficult legally in Switzerland to accept the official marks of other countries. By contrast, there would be fewer problems in accepting the marks of an international character.

Mr BERTRAN raised a number of problems which, in his view, would have to be resolved before trying to set up a certification system ;

- the system might comprise certification of patterns of instruments, certification of individual instruments, or both ;
- was the creation of a system compatible with the Convention by which OIML was constituted ?
- was the creation of a system compatible with Member States' legislation ?

He proposed that the Bureau study these questions before all else.

Mr CLAPHAM, in expressing his support for the last remarks, said that, for example, it was not possible in the United Kingdom to accept an instrument bearing the OIML mark, for the regulations concerning the meanings of marks were very strict. There would also have to be protection against the fraudulent use of the mark, for example by a manufacturer who himself placed the mark on the instruments he produced, whether dishonestly or in good faith, because he thought that the instruments satisfied OIML. Finally there would have to be some assurance that the national authorities themselves knew what they were doing in applying the mark, and could therefore be relied on.

Mr KOCH did not want to criticise the rather hesitant views that had been expressed, but nevertheless it was necessary that OIML should have a mark of conformity, and have it quickly. That mark would be purely informative in nature, not binding. Countries could, nevertheless, and purely voluntarily, recognise the mark as equivalent to the national marks in particular instances, for example where there was a bilateral agreement.

Mrs LÄHTEENMÄKI agreed with Mr KOCH's view and pointed out that there had been discussions within EFTA which had led to similar conclusions in support of the establishment of an OIML mark.

Mr BIRKELAND summarised the views that had been expressed and suggested a programme that the Bureau could follow to pursue work on this topic.

In conclusion the Committee adopted the following resolution :

The International Committee of Legal Metrology,

HAVING HEARD the oral comments made by some of its Members on the appropriateness of establishing an OIML system of certification or an OIML mark,

RECALLING the studies already completed on this subject by an ad hoc group in the years 1975 to 1982,

CONCLUDES that the time has come to restart work on the subject,

INSTRUCTS the Bureau to make the analyses, compilations and enquiries it deems appropriate,

CHARGES the Presidential Council with the supervision of this work and the submission of a progress report to the next meeting of the Committee.

8. PREPARATIONS FOR THE EIGHTH CONFERENCE

8.1. Reports from the host country and from BIML on preparations for the Conference

Mr BIRCH detailed fully the preparations for the Eighth Conference, which had been invited by the Australian government to meet at Sydney in October 1988, a year which would also see the celebration of the Bicentenary of the European Settlement on the continent. Mr ATHANÉ added some administrative details.

On behalf of the Committee Mr BIRKELAND thanked Mr BIRCH for all these preparations to ensure the success of the Conference.

8.2. The Conference agenda

Mr ATHANÉ submitted a preliminary draft agenda for the Conference which the Committee found generally acceptable.

8.3. Preliminary budgetary proposals for the financial period 1989 to 1992

Mr BIRKELAND introduced the Bureau's proposal in the hope that Committee Members were conscious of the amount of work with which the Bureau was burdened. He hoped that they were aware that it was the Committee's responsibility then to help the Bureau in formulating sound arguments in support of a budgetary request that was as convincing as possible and which the Member States could accept at the Conference.

Mr BIRKELAND added that it was also the responsibility of Committee Members to contact their authorities and to make every effort to convince them of the need to accept the proposed budget.

Mr EDGERLY expressed his general support for the budgetary proposal. He thought, nevertheless, that it would be wise to bring out the fact that the Member States' subscriptions, and therefore the increases requested, were really very low in absolute value if they were compared, for example, with other organizations' budgets. It would be better, then, to present the requested increases as an absolute value and not as a percentage.

Mr EDGERLY added, however, that while he totally approved of the increase requested in order to recruit an extra person for the Bureau, he found the sum envisaged for the rearrangement of the building to accommodate this increase in personnel much less justified.

Mr BIRKELAND thought that the budgetary proposal would be easier to read if the sums were rounded to thousands of francs and expressed in kilofrancs.

Mr BERTRAN said that the French authorities seemed to understand the need to increase the number of people working at BIML. On the other hand they asked that the building expenses be both reduced and spread over as long a period as possible.

Mr PETERSEN suggested that it be explained that the budget for the operation of the Bureau represented only a part of the total expense committed by the Member States of OIML.

Mr BIRKELAND thought that that argument could work well with some financial administrations or in some countries, but not in every case. He asked his colleagues to use that argument if they thought it appropriate but he preferred that it should not appear in the paper which the Bureau would prepare for the Conference.

Mr FABER observed that OIML had developed greatly in fifteen years without the benefit of any increase in the Bureau's staff complement. He thought, therefore, that the Bureau could be congratulated on its work and efficiency. He supported the budgetary request submitted by the Bureau, but he thought that it would be as well to insist more on the fact that the work programme for 1989 to 1992 was going to be very finely screened and that the increase in the activities of OIML was a necessary increase brought on by the reality of the situation and not an artificial or bureaucratic growth.

Mr ISSAEV feared that the increase which was sought for 1989 might be too big for some Member States. He thought, moreover, that it would be wise to make it plain that the increase requested for the rearrangement of the building was a temporary increase which would not be repeated in the following financial period.

Mr HASCHE was strong in his support for the idea that permanent expenses, recurring in several budgetary periods, should be clearly distinguished from occasional expenses, which occurred only once.

Mr FANNING said that in Ireland, as in many other countries, it was practically impossible for an administration to obtain an increase in personnel because of the current financial situation. Consequently the Bureau's request must be thoroughly justified, and therefore some inconsistencies which appeared in the Bureau's proposal should be removed. It said, for example, on one page that the Bureau had been able up to now to keep pace with the increase in the work load ; on another page it said that the programme for 1989 to 1992 represented an amount of work almost equivalent to that of the previous programme. The need to recruit an extra member of staff was far from evident !

Mr OHLON thought the document should bring out more forcefully the impact of OIML's activities and the resulting benefits enjoyed by Member States. For example, OIML's work allowed other institutions such as CAEM, EEC, EFTA... to develop the standards and directives they needed more rapidly and at less cost.

Mr BIRKELAND wound up the discussion by thanking his colleagues for all the positive opinions and counsels that they had given of the Bureau, and he asked the latter to prepare the final draft of the budgetary proposal for submission to the Conference.

9. DEVELOPING COUNTRIES

Mr THULIN summarised the Bureau's activities since the last meeting of the Committee which were of interest to developing countries :

- the production of some new brochures,
- bringing older brochures up to date,

- the transmission to industrialised countries of enquiries from developing countries about training and the supply of equipment,
- a study at the request of one developing country of the cost of the necessary metrological equipment,
- supervision of the work programme laid down by the Development Council at its last meeting.

On the subject of brochures, Mr THULIN said that Cuba had translated some of them into Spanish. In addition he envisaged starting the preparation of a new brochure on the calibration facilities in certain countries which were available to other countries.

With regard to training Mr THULIN reminded the Committee that Cuba had undertaken to mount an annual training course in metrology, open to trainees from other countries.

Finally it was confirmed that Cuba and the Bureau would organise a week of meetings with a seminar, a meeting of SP 31, a meeting of the Development Council and an exhibition of measuring instruments at Havana in April 1988.

Mr GOMEZ ROSELL, President of the Development Council, confirmed and completed the information given by Mr THULIN. The meetings in April 1988 would be organised at Havana's International Conference Centre, which could offer all the facilities needed for this kind of meeting. Besides the Member States and Corresponding Members of OIML, some Latin-American states would be invited. Full details of hotel reservations, transport, etc. would be sent out later.

At Mr HASCHE's request, the Bureau indicated that it would also distribute soon a provisional agenda and seek after countries likely to send lecturers on selected subjects.

At Mr THULIN's request, some Committee Members indicated their intention to take part themselves in the meetings or to send representatives.

Mr ATHANÉ confirmed that the budget for 1988 included funds to allow four representatives of developing countries to be invited to the meetings in Cuba.

Mr BIRKELAND concluded the discussion by thanking Mr GOMEZ ROSELL for what Cuba was doing for the developing countries, in close cooperation with the Bureau.

10. CATEGORIES OF OIML PUBLICATIONS

Mr EDGERLY reminded the Committee that the Presidential Council had given him the task of producing a proposal whose object would be to make official the publication by the Bureau of brochures which fall neither into the category of International Recommendations nor into that of International Documents. These brochures could come originally from the Bureau itself or from a Pilot Secretariat or Reporting Secretariat (and in the last case would have been approved by the International Working Group of the Secretariat), or from other sources. They would be examined by the Bureau, and the decision whether or not to publish them would be the Director's. These brochures could cover very different fields : information manuals for developing countries, compilations of existing Recommendations, reports, etc.

Mr THULIN pointed out that some years earlier the Bureau has produced some brochures which were meant particularly for developing countries. It had quickly become apparent that some of them were of much wider interest, and other brochures had been produced for the use of all Member States and Corresponding States. However, the distribution of these brochures had been confined, as before, to those states ; they had not been sent to private users (manufacturers, private laboratories...) except in exceptional circumstances. The Bureau had nevertheless reconsidered this question ; and the sale of these brochures, in the same manner as International Recommendations and Documents, was envisaged.

In reply to a question from Mr FABER the respective roles of the Pilot or Reporting Secretariats and the Bureau were clarified as regards brochures prepared by a Secretariat.

Mr BIRKELAND closed the discussion in concluding that the Committee accepted this proposal. He left to the Bureau the task of resolving questions of detail such as designations, possible numbering systems, etc. for these brochures.

11. OIML SEMINARS

Mr THULIN spoke of the seminar on the measurement of large quantities of liquids, which the Bureau had organised at Arles, in the south of France, in April 1987, with the support of the French metrological authorities and, as regarded the visits and technical demonstrations, the help of French industrial enterprises. The seminar had been a great success ; 63 people had taken part, coming from numerous Member States, from one Corresponding Member (Albania), and from one country which was not a member (Saudi Arabia). A detailed account of the proceedings had been published in the OIML Bulletin of September 1987.

Mr THULIN added that with the seminars of 1981, 1983, 1985 and 1987 a start had been made on all the most important subjects in legal metrology, but no doubt a return to some of them could be justified by the technical progress that had been made. For September 1989, for example, another seminar on weighing could be organised, perhaps on the checking of electronic instruments.

Mr KOCHSIEK said that the PTB was prepared to cooperate with the Bureau in organising this seminar, which could be about the application of the RI on « Non-automatic weighing instruments », of which a new version would be approved by the Eighth Conference.

Mr BENKIRANE asked that thought be given to organising a seminar on the setting up and running of laboratories for calibration and testing, a subject which was currently of great importance to developing countries.

Mr THULIN supported that proposal and thought that this type of seminar could be organised at regional level, as was already being done, for example, in the framework of the Asia-Pacific Metrology Programme (APMP). The Bureau could try first to organise such a seminar for the French-speaking countries of Africa with the help of the industrialised countries concerned.

Mr BIRKELAND, in closing the discussion, encouraged the Bureau to implement the two proposals that had been put forward.

12. REPORT ON THE ACTIVITIES OF BIML

The Committee noted a report, of which copies were distributed during the meeting, which described in broad terms the work of BIML since the preceding meeting of the Committee in April 1986.

13. LIAISON WITH OTHER INTERNATIONAL INSTITUTIONS

- a) Mr ATHANÉ spoke about cooperation between BIPM, IEC, ISO and BIML, in particular about the revision of the VIM and about the work in progress on the expression of uncertainties, for which the working group had met twice at BIML.

Mr ISSAEV added some remarks about the production of an ISO document on the metrological aspects of standardization.

- b) M. PETIK reported on the metrological aspects of the « meeting of government officials responsible for standardization policy » in the United Nations Economic

Commission for Europe (UN-ECE), and on the part played by the Bureau. He said that reports on the work of OIML, especially that of SPs 21, 22 and 23, would be drafted, with coordination by the Bureau, for a seminar to be organised by UN-ECE in June 1988.

14. TERMINOLOGY

On Mr PODGORSKI's behalf Mr REFEROWSKI said that Poland, who had general responsibility for OIML's work on terminology, agreed with the Bureau that, at least for the time being, a decision to maintain the status quo be adopted: keep the existing « terminology » secretariats until the completion of their work, no new « terminology » secretariats to be formed, but each Reporting Secretariat working on a given instrument to be responsible for including in the RI's or DI's concerned the specific definitions needed for the understanding of these texts. Clearly these specific terminologies would have to conform to the general rules established by SP 1-Sr 2.

Mr REFEROWSKI added that Poland had no objection to the adoption by the Committee, in accordance with the rules applicable to International Documents, of the VML and other vocabularies in course of preparation.

Mr BIRKELAND thought that this question could be settled along the lines suggested by Poland, and he instructed the Bureau to submit a final report to the Committee within an appropriate time.

CLOSURE

Mr EDGERLY announced that as a result of his appointment as head of another division of the NATIONAL BUREAU OF STANDARDS he would have to give up the positions he held within OIML. He spoke of the pleasure that his long association with the work and development of OIML had given him over many years, and of his hope that the Organization would continue in its successful path. He introduced Dr S. CHAPPELL, the USA's new representative on the Committee.

Messrs BIRKELAND and ATHANÉ both expressed keen appreciation of the role that Mr EDGERLY had played in OIML's development since 1972, the year in which the USA joined OIML, first in support of the USA's representatives in the Committee, then as himself Member and Vice-President of CIML. They stressed how Mr EDGERLY's role had been essential not only in enlisting the participation of American industry in the work of OIML but in improving the working methods of the Organization itself.

Finally Mr BIRKELAND thanked all his colleagues on the Committee for their active participation in that Twenty-Second Meeting; and in the name of all those present he also expressed his appreciation of the efforts of all who had contributed to bringing it about.

RESOLUTIONS and DECISIONS

DECISION CIML 1987 — POINT 1

The Committee approved the report of the 21st CIML meeting with the following modifications :

Page 6, Delegations of votes - add :

Mr ASAD HASAN (Pakistan) to Mr NIEUWLAND (Netherlands), on 18 April

Page 8, 2nd line (French version only) -

read « représentant » in place of « Membre ».

Page 11, point 2.1., after « April 1985 » add « and of new Corresponding Members (Costa-Rica, Ghana, Iceland and Oman)... ».

Page 15, after the first 4 lines, add a paragraph :

« The Committee takes note of the fact that some Reporting Secretariats (SP 6-Sr 6, SP 17-Sr 3) must be considered as temporarily inactive, since no State volunteers at present to assume responsibility for them. »

DECISION CIML 1987 — POINT 2

The Committee took note of the report on the accessions of Portugal as Member Country and of Barbados as Corresponding Member, on the prospects of new accessions and on the situation of Venezuela.

DECISION CIML 1987 — POINT 3.1

The Committee approved the auditor's reports for 1985 and 1986 and instructed its President and the Director of the Bureau to submit them to the Eighth Conference.

DECISION CIML 1987 — POINT 3.2

The Committee took note of the report on the financial situation of the Organization for 1987 and of the estimates for 1988.

DECISIONS CIML 1987 — POINT 4

The Committee :

- renewed the contract of Mr THULIN, Assistant Director, from the date of expiry of the current contract (September 1988) and up to the age limit fixed by BIML staff regulations,*
- annulled its Decision CIML 1986 — Point 4.1, relating to the extension of the contract of Mr PETIK, Assistant Director, for 2 years, and replaced it by a 5-year renewal from the date of expiry of the first contract (June 1986).*

DECISION CIML 1987 — POINT 5.1

The Committee took note of the report on the planning exercise for the period 1985 to 1988.

RESOLUTION CIML 1987 — POINT 5.2

The International Committee of Legal Metrology

HAVING TAKEN NOTE of the comments, submitted by certain Member States, on the preparations for the planning period 1989 to 1992,

HAVING TAKEN NOTE of the proposals of the Bureau,

HAVING HEARD the oral comments of Committee Members,

NOTING that planning criteria are required so that the plan for 1989 to 1992 may be prepared in time,

INVITES Committee Members to inform the Bureau of their views on planning criteria and priorities and on the criteria for the inclusion of a subject in the work programme,

INSTRUCTS the Bureau to compile the information and views of Committee Members on this subject and to bring them to the attention of the Presidential Council,

CHARGES the Presidential Council with considering and weighing the views expressed and with making a recommendation to the 23rd meeting of the Committee,

INSTRUCTS the Bureau to proceed with the other aspects of the planning exercise for the period 1989 to 1992 in accordance with the proposals of BIML presented at the meeting.

DECISION CIML 1987 — POINT 6.1

The Committee took note of the state of progress of the work of OIML Secretariats.

DECISIONS CIML 1987 — POINT 6.2

The Committee

- *assigned to the German Democratic Republic responsibility for the Reporting Secretariats SP 11-Sr 2 « Hierarchy scheme for pressure measuring instruments » and SP 14-Sr 3 « Mechanical vibration and shock »*
- *assigned to the People's Republic of China responsibility for the Reporting Secretariat SP 14-Sr 1 « Sound level meters »*
- *postponed to a later date the creation of the Reporting Secretariat SP 23-Sr 6 « Principles of horizontal intercomparisons (measuring standards of the same level) » while awaiting the candidature of a State willing to undertake responsibility for it*

- *created and assigned to Czechoslovakia the Reporting Secretariat SP 23-Sr 7 « Recalibration intervals of measurement standards and devices used for calibration and verification » (international working group and liaison with other international institutions to be set up by BIML)*
- *created and assigned to the United States of America the Reporting Secretariat SP 5D-Sr 10 « Direct mass flow measurement of quantities of liquids » (international working group and liaison with other international institutions to be set up by BIML)*
- *created and assigned to Australia the Reporting Secretariat SP 5S-Sr 12 « Static direct mass measurement of quantities of liquids » (international working group and liaison with other international institutions to be set up by BIML)*
- *discontinued the Reporting Secretariats*
SP 2-Sr 3 « Legal qualification of measuring instruments »
SP 27-Sr 6 « Prescriptions concerning the contents of reference material certificates »
SP 27-Sr 8 « Information concerning reference materials »
- *took note of the new descriptive titles of SP 22-Sr 4 and SP 23*
- *took note of France's request that responsibility for SP 5S « Static measurement of quantities of liquids » be assumed by another Member State as soon as possible.*

RESOLUTION CIML 1987 — POINT 6.3

The International Committee of Legal Metrology

HAVING TAKEN NOTE of the comments on the « Working Method of OIML Secretariats » submitted by certain Member States,

HAVING TAKEN NOTE of the Bureau's proposals,

HAVING HEARD the oral comments of Committee Members,

RECOGNISING that the provisions contained in the « Working Method of OIML Secretariats » are in general entirely appropriate,

CONSIDERING nevertheless that some points of detail could be completed or improved,

CONSIDERING that the problems that arise are almost always due to incorrect implementation of these provisions, mainly due to their being poorly known,

INSTRUCTS the Bureau to proceed to the necessary improvements and additions, under the supervision of the Presidential Council,

INSTRUCTS the Bureau to prepare summaries of these provisions, in particular for the information of participants in Secretariats' meetings,

REMINDS the Members of the Committee that it is their duty to ensure that the Secretariats for which their countries are responsible or in which their countries participate adhere strictly to these provisions.

DECISIONS CIML 1987 — POINT 7

- *The Committee noted the report of the Bureau and the information given by Members of the Committee on the application of Resolutions CIML 1986 —*

POINTS 13.1 (information on bi-lateral and multi-lateral agreements), 13.2 (exchange of information on the results of pattern approval tests) and 13.3 (declarations of conformity of an instrument or of a batch of instruments appropriately identified).

- *The Committee instructed the Bureau to develop, using a model already presented and taking into account comments made during the meeting, a draft declaration of conformity of a pattern ; to take advice from states having already considered issuing certificates of this kind ; and to place this draft before the Presidential Council, accompanied by whatever comment is necessary, for transmission to the Committee at its next meeting.*

RESOLUTION CIML 1987 — POINT 7

The International Committee of Legal Metrology

HAVING HEARD the oral comments made by some of its Members, on the appropriateness of establishing an OIML certification system or an OIML mark,

RECALLING the studies already completed on this subject by an ad hoc group in the years 1975 to 1982,

CONCLUDES that the time has come to restart work on this subject,

INSTRUCTS the Bureau to make the analyses, compilations and enquiries it deems appropriate,

CHARGES the Presidential Council with the supervision of this work and the submission of a progress report at the next meeting of the Committee.

DECISION CIML 1987 — POINT 8.1

The Committee took note of reports submitted by the Committee Member for Australia and by the Bureau on preparations for the Eighth Conference.

DECISION CIML 1987 — POINT 8.2

The Committee took note of a draft agenda for the Eighth Conference.

DECISION CIML 1987 — POINT 8.3

The Committee took note of a draft budgetary proposal for 1989 to 1992, and it suggested to the Bureau how some of the arguments developed in the draft might be improved.

DECISION CIML 1987 — POINT 9

The Committee took note of the reports presented by the President of the Development Council and by the Bureau, expressed its appreciation of the actions

taken, particularly of the organisation of a meeting in Cuba of the Development Council, together with a meeting of SP 31 and a seminar.

DECISION CIML 1987 — POINT 10

The Committee took note of the proposals relating to various categories of publications and instructed the Bureau to modify the « Working method of OIML Secretariats » accordingly.

DECISION CIML 1987 — POINT 11

The Committee took note of the report on technical seminars and expressed its appreciation of this activity of the Bureau ; it encouraged the Federal Republic of Germany and the Bureau to organise a seminar on non-automatic weighing instruments in 1989 ; it also took note of a suggestion that regional seminars on laboratories for calibration and testing, and on problems of calibration and verification, of special interest to developing countries, be organised.

DECISION CIML 1987 — POINT 12

The Committee took note of the report on the activities of the BIML during the period April 1986 — August 1987 and expressed its appreciation.

DECISION CIML 1987 — POINT 13

The Committee noted reports on liaison between OIML and certain International Institutions and encouraged the Bureau and the working groups of OIML to continue their cooperative efforts.

DECISION CIML 1987 — POINT 14

The Committee noted a report on the terminological work of OIML, expressed its agreement with the proposals submitted and instructed SP 1 and the Bureau to report back on this subject at an appropriate time.

DECISION CIML 1987 — CLOSURE

The Committee took note of the fact that Mr David E. EDGERLY was obliged by the application of Article XIII of the Convention to relinquish his responsibilities as Member for the United States of America and Vice-President of the International Committee of Legal Metrology.

It expressed its keen appreciation of all that Mr David E. EDGERLY had done since 1972.

